



HTML navigation elements 30m

What is an HTML navigation element?

A navigation element defines a section that has navigation links. These links may be internal (within the current document) or external (to another document). A navigation element is written as `<nav>` in HTML and is used to define a set of navigation links such as a table of contents, menu or index.

Not all links in a document need to be within a `<nav>` element. For example, the `<footer>` element, which defines the footer section of a document, often has internal links to copyright information, which is not within a `<nav>` element. A navigation element is only intended for major blocks of links.

The `<a>` element specifies a hyperlink, which is defined using the `href` attribute. It also allows you to add bookmarks in an HTML document, which is useful when the page is too long to scroll through. In this case, the `id` attribute identifies the bookmark which is linked using the `href` attribute.

How do HTML navigation elements work?

When using a `<nav>` element, you also need an `<a>` element and an `href` attribute. An `<a>` element is used to specify a hyperlink, while the `href` attribute is used to indicate the actual link.

[Skip to main content](#)

HTML links can also be used to create bookmarks in an HTML document, which is useful for pages with a lot of content. Bookmarks allow a user to navigate straight to a specific section of a web page. In this case, the `id` attribute identifies the bookmark, which is linked using the `href` attribute.

In the following example (5.16), we will show you how to define a navigation section using the `<nav>` element.

We return to the code used to create the BIT703 course page. We've now improved the navigation section for the 'Work towards' section. Notice how we've grouped the links together using the `<nav>` element.

Have a go at editing the navigation elements. Test your knowledge by adding another link to the 'Work towards' section. This link needs to navigate to Course Only (Certificate of Proficiency). Test your code in CodePen, then submit your code in the activity below to see our feedback.



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>

<head>
  <title>Enrolment
  Information</title>
</head>

<body>
  <section id="how-to-enrol">
    <header>
      <h2>How to Enrol</h2>
    </header>
    <p>Before enrolling in this
course you need to:</p>
    <ul>
      <li>choose the
qualification you will study the
course under</li>
      <li>check the order
that courses in the qualification
should be studied in the
Qualification Structure table. This
is in the Choose courses and apply
tab on the qualification page.
</li>
    </ul>
  </section>

```

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Example 5.16 Navigation elements



☒ Create a navigation link

Non-Assessed

Status: Done
Skip to main content

Reset ↺

1. In this activity, you'll enhance your HTML skills by creating a navigation link to the [Course Only \(Certificate of Proficiency\) web page](#). Use the CodePen example 5.16 provided above to test your knowledge of adding navigation links.
2. Specifically, you'll add a link within the 'Work towards' section that directs users to the 'Course Only (Certificate of Proficiency)' page.

☒ I have completed this activity



Were you able to successfully create a functional navigation link to 'Course Only (Certificate of Proficiency)'? Test your link to ensure it opens correctly. If you encounter any issues, compare your code to our example and identify where you went wrong. Task: Create a navigation link

Previous attempts ▼



Let's now investigate the various HTML classes available to categorise HTML elements.



Thoughts on this page?

